

IAS MAINS 2020

VALUE ADDITION

GS - I

GS - II

GS - III

GS - IV

12 QUESTIONS WITH MODEL ANSWERS

MODULE - 17

GS – I ... INDIAN SOCIETY

- 37 “With the rise in education and affluence of women, divorce rates are on increase”. Do you agree? Give reasoned arguments. (250 Words)
- 38 With the affluence and materialistic possessions becoming the benchmarks for social status, examine its implications on traditional family relations in India. (150 Words)
- 39 Youth are not interested in agriculture and the industry / services ecosystem is not able to create the required jobs for absorbing the youth from agriculture. If one takes the long-term perspective, what will be its implications? (250 Words)

GS – II ... SOCIAL JUSTICE & GOVERNANCE

- 28 Though Swachh Bharat Mission and Smart Cities Mission were planned almost at the same time, one has seen spectacular success and the other not so successful. How do you explain this paradox? (250 Words)
- 29 Examine how the worker is empowered through the Code on Wages Act, 2019. What can be the probable challenges in its implementation? (250 Words)
- 30 Examine how the recent Companies (Amendment) Act, 2019 is in tune with the “Minimum Government - Maximum Governance”. (150 Words)

GS – III ... ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT

- 28 Explain with recent examples, how “Conflict of Interest”, “Related-party Transactions” and “Shell Companies” became major ethical concerns in corporate governance. (250 Words)
- 29 What do you understand by “pro-crony policies”? How do they go against the principles of social justice? Explain with recent examples. (250 Words)
- 30 What are the fundamental differences between the concepts of “Global Value Chains” and “Assemble in India”? What policy perspectives are required to make “Assemble in India” a success story? (150 Words)

GS – IV ... ETHICS, INTEGRITY & APTITUDE

- 49 What is tolerance? Elaborate the importance of tolerance. (150 Words)
- 50 Why and how should a civil servant be compassionate towards weaker sections? (250 Words)
- 51 Discuss the ways to ensure ethical corporate governance from the perspective of government and public. (250 Words)

**“With the rise in education and affluence of women, divorce rates are on increase”.
Do you agree? Give reasoned arguments. (250 Words)**

As per UN report, while non-marriage remains extremely rare in India, the number of divorces has doubled over the past two decades. Despite increase in rate of divorce, only 1.1% of women are divorced, with those in urban areas making up the largest proportion in India. This reflects that the rise in education and affluence of women can be a reason for increasing divorce.

EDUCATION AND AFFLUENCE OF WOMEN - INCREASING DIVORCE RATE

1. Progressively changing women and traditionally unchanging men increased conflicts in family.
2. Expectations on satisfied marriage life are changing relative to previous generations.
3. Financial independence of women provided the freedom to reject.
4. Progressive employed women want restructuring of traditional gender roles.
5. Laws are more women friendly and simplified to get divorce.
6. Increased awareness regarding female rights, marital rape etc.
7. Materialism and money making taking over family emotions in urban areas.
8. Marriage and motherhood are reducing opportunities for women to enter labour market.
9. Freedom to choose involved freedom to live liberally with no restrictions.



THE WAY AHEAD

Policymakers, activists and people should collaborate to transform families into places of equality and justice where women can exercise choice and voice. Further, recommended steps are:

- Family laws are to be amended and reformed to ensure women can choose whether, when and whom to marry.
- Enable women's access to family resources.
- Provide the possibility of divorce, if needed.
- Laws to criminalize marital rape to be enacted.
- Innovative campaigns focusing on family emotions and values is needed.

With the affluence and materialistic possessions becoming the benchmarks for social status, examine its implications on traditional family relations in India. (150 Words)

Globalisation and urbanisation has resulted in changing benchmark of social status to affluence, materialistic possessions and consumerism. It has multiple implications on traditional Indian family system.

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graph TD; A[IMPLICATIONS] --> B[POSITIVE]; A --> C[NEGATIVE]; B --> D["▪ Reducing tendencies for son preference<br/>▪ Raising gender equal consciousness in nurturing children<br/>▪ Increasing inter-caste marriages and reducing caste consciousness<br/>▪ Economic independence for women<br/>▪ Enhancement in women's agency and freedom"]; C --> E["CNTD..."]
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IMPLICATIONS

POSITIVE

- Reducing tendencies for son preference
- Raising gender equal consciousness in nurturing children
- Increasing inter-caste marriages and reducing caste consciousness
- Economic independence for women
- Enhancement in women's agency and freedom

NEGATIVE

CNTD...



IMPLICATIONS

POSITIVE

NEGATIVE

- Disintegration of joint families
- Increasing single parent families
- Reducing sanctity for traditional marriage system
- Old age homes and creches taking the roles of families
- Emergence of new family types like LGBT
- Materialism and affluence dominating family emotions
- Increased loneliness and atmosphere of depression leading to suicides
- Nurturing children without values due to absence of elders
- Close family relations being replaced by friends on social media
- Increasing divorce rate in urban areas

CONCLUSION

While the positives can be embraced by traditional family system in India, the negative implications need to be countered by reorganizing family value systems and recognizing women's due share. Elderly people as a guide to a better life has to be institutionalized.

39 / IS
GS - I

Youth are not interested in agriculture and the industry / services ecosystem is not able to create the required jobs for absorbing the youth from agriculture. If one takes the long-term perspective, what will be its implications? (250 Words)

The median age in India will be 28 years by 2022 with working age population numerically outstripping the non-working age population. But the aversion towards agriculture and absence of jobs in manufacturing for youth can become a demographic challenge in the long run.

LONG-TERM IMPLICATIONS

1. ECONOMIC

- Fall in consumption and thereby demand further resulting in economic depression
- Low quality employment in informal sector and Gig economy
- Poor contribution to GDP growth
- Under employment in manufacturing/services ecosystem while disguised unemployment in agriculture
- Perpetuation of jobless growth

2. SOCIAL

- Results in frustrated and disillusioned youth
- Increases crime rate and creates social unrest
- Reemergence of polarizing ideologies like 'sons of soil' ideology
- Vulnerability of economic migrants being exploited
- Issues of child labour and human trafficking may increase
- Radicalization of youth by terror outfits



3. POLITICAL

- Perpetuation of populist policies of economic doles and loan waivers
- Misguiding disillusioned youth towards protests for reservations etc.
- Politically flared social unrest may increase

GOVERNMENT MEASURES TO COUNTER

1. Attracting and Retaining of Youth in Agriculture (ARYA)
2. Promoting innovation in agri-allied activities
3. Focus on job creation through export promotion policies
4. Startup India and standup India to promote entrepreneurship
5. Measures to ensure credit availability to MSMEs

WAY AHEAD

Employment creation through multiple avenues like rural outsourcing, strengthening ITIs on par with IITs and infrastructure support for agriculture and manufacturing is needed. Further, quality education, nutrition and upskilling in consistence with emerging job market requirements is necessary.



28 / SJG
GS - II

Though Swachh Bharat Mission and Smart Cities Mission were planned almost at the same time, one has seen spectacular success and the other not so successful. How do you explain this paradox? (250 Words)

Swachh Bharat Mission and Smart Cities Mission are two flagship schemes that witnessed different trajectories because of the approach and inherent requirements being different for both.

	SMART CITIES MISSION	SWACHH BHARAT MISSION
NATURE	Infrastructure and investment based	Behavioral change program as its core
COMMUNICATION	- Lack of clarity on whether the mission is for high end or basic infrastructure - Poor bureaucratic will - Absence of public trust on its implementation	- Prime Minister was the communicator in Chief - Grass root volunteers, "Swachhagrahis" for door to door communication - Roped in celebrities to create awareness - Strengthened public belief in government's efforts



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	SMART CITIES MISSION	SWACHH BHARAT MISSION
PRIORITIES	▪ Lopsided priorities in investing funds	▪ Prioritizing and step by step implementation like ODF, ODF+, ODF++
COORDINATION	▪ Absence of coordination among various government agencies	▪ Congruence of goal from Centre to state to Panchayat in a mission mode ▪ Ensured people participation by making it a Jan Andolan ▪ Team-SBM-Grameen engaged directly with collectors through workshops, WhatsApp groups etc.
PEOPLE PARTICIPATION	▪ Not much efforts were made to create awareness about need of such cities	▪ Mission is democratized with people participation ▪ People constructed their own toilets and motivated others ▪ Villages declared themselves open defecation free

EVALUATION

SMART CITIES MISSION

- No third-party evaluation

FOLLOW - THROUGH

- No whereabouts of such news

SWACHH BHARAT MISSION

- 3rd party monitoring of progress was encouraged
- International organizations like World Bank conducted assessment of sanitation coverage
- Focused on further sustaining the success
- Recently, a forward looking 10 year sanitation strategy was released articulating the goal of moving from ODF to ODF+

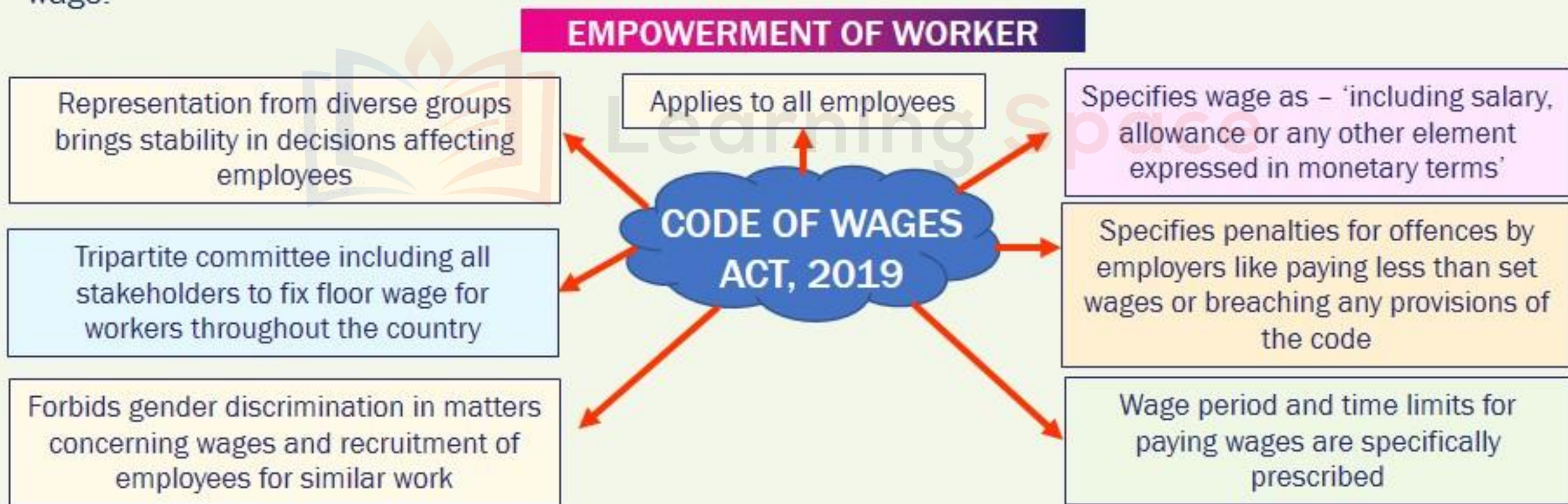
FINAL WORD

Learning from the success of Swachh Bharat and ensuring that infrastructural and investment needs are duly addressed can streamline the Smart cities mission. It can be made successful by following participatory, democratic approach.

29 / SJG
GS - II

Examine how the worker is empowered through the Code on Wages Act, 2019. What can be the probable challenges in its implementation? (250 Words)

Code of Wages Act, 2019 is part of restructuring 44 labour laws into 4 labour codes to enhance ease of doing business. It subsumes previous laws regarding wages and empower worker in securing minimum wage.



While the code of wages is a step in right direction, it has its own pitfalls.



CHALLENGES TO IMPLEMENTING THE CODE

- Implementing and maintaining surveillance over small and unorganized businesses across different states require not only planning but also investment of resources and energy by centre and state.
- While reeling under GST system, implementing the code imposes higher costs.
- Aim to correct a diverse range of issues for the employees without one clear goal would leave no goal touched.
- Employees may hire fewer workers to reduce costs.
- Legitimizes and promotes contractualization of labour.
- Increase in wages would raise cost of living.

THE WAY AHEAD

Balancing the interests of both the workers and employees such that both ease of doing business and job creation are not hampered should guide the law. Taking cue from the international best practices is necessary.



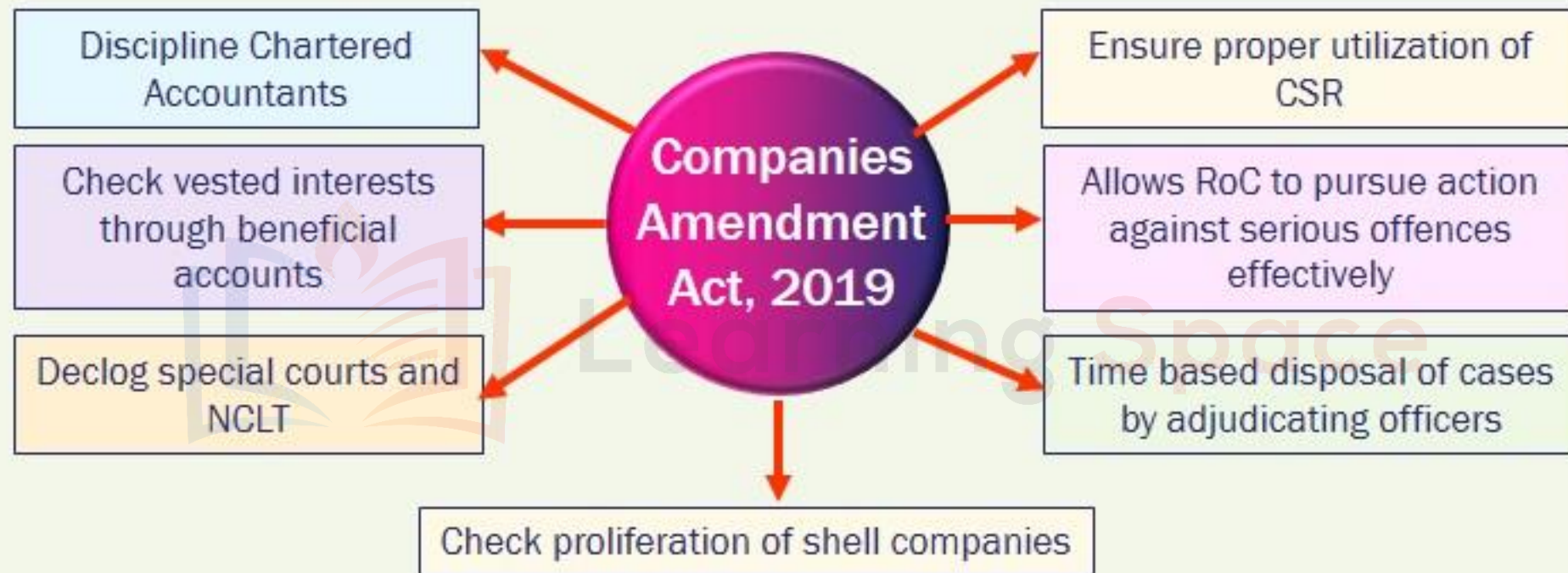
Examine how the recent Companies (Amendment) Act, 2019 is in tune with the “Minimum Government - Maximum Governance”. (150 Words)

Companies Amendment Act, 2019 has comprehensively amended Companies Act, 2013 in pursuance of its policy of ‘Minimum Government – Maximum Governance’ and providing ease of doing business to law-abiding corporates.

SALIENT FEATURES OF AMENDMENT



TOWARDS MINIMUM GOVERNMENT – MAXIMUM GOVERNANCE



CONCLUSION

Implementation of provisions in letter and spirit needs bureaucratic will to ensure ethics in corporate governance.

Explain with recent examples, how “Conflict of Interest”, “Related-party Transactions” and “Shell Companies” became major ethical concerns in corporate governance. (250 Words)

Corporate governance in India hits a low with multiple economic offences being unbundled. They include the issues of conflict of interest in Chanda Kochhar's case, related-party transactions in Indigo case and shell companies formed by promoters of DHFL.

ETHICAL CONCERNS IN CORPORATE GOVERNANCE

1. Conflict of interest:

- Lead to bias towards personal affairs while discharging professional duty
- Lack of transparency and alleged conflict of interest created extensive damage to the stakeholders and reputation of ICICI bank
- Violated code of conduct –
 - ✓ by withholding information against disclosure norms
 - ✓ by not reporting conflict of interest to group compliance officer



2. Related Party Transactions:

- A deal between two parties, who have pre-existing business relationship or common interest or among the relatives.
 - Eg: SEBI alleged Indigo's violations of corporate governance and listing disclosure norms in certain related party transactions with Indigo's parent firm
- Adversely affects the trust of stakeholders' governance which is reflected in fall of the share value.

3. Shell Companies:

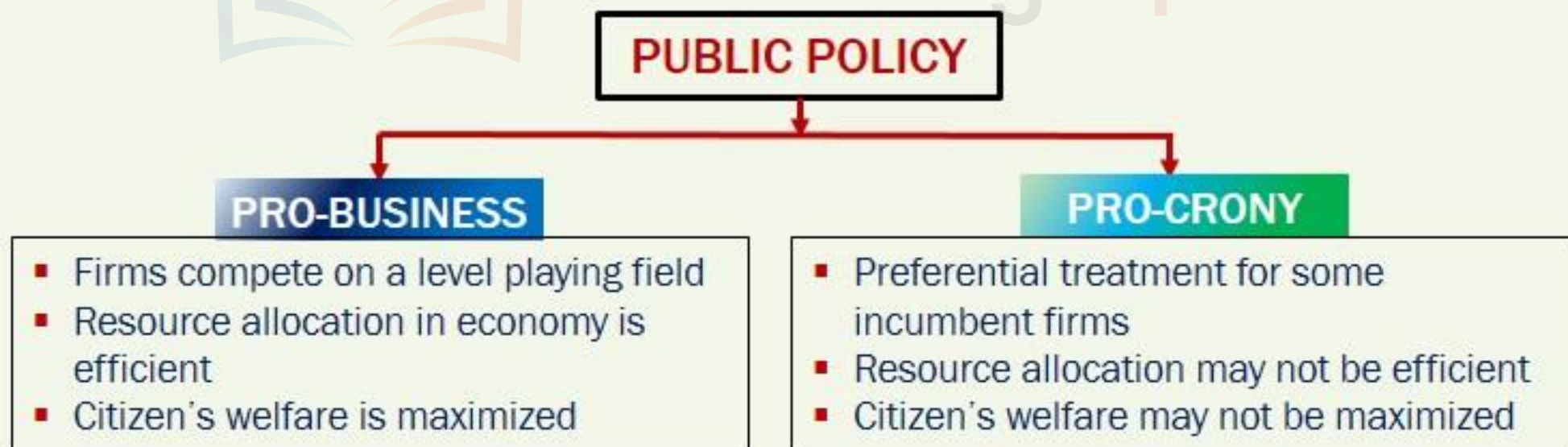
- Multiple layers of companies created for diverting money or money laundering without active business operations or significant assets.
- Eg: Enforcement directorate (ED) revealed that the promoters of DHFL created five shell companies to divert Rs. 2000 Crores
- Reflects the loop holes and inefficiencies of legal infrastructure that secures corporate governance.

CONCLUSION

These are a few among many instances of governance lapses in corporate India. It is high time that the regulators should act diligently with implementation of Companies Amendment Act, 2019 in its letter and spirit and enact multiple reforms as needed.

What do you understand by “pro-crony policies”? How do they go against the principles of social justice? Explain with recent examples. (250 Words)

- Economic survey 2020 stressed the necessity to discard Pro-crony policies by embracing Pro-business policies to realise the goal of \$5 trillion economy by 2024-25.
- Pro-crony policies include public policy making being influenced to favour specific private interests, especially powerful incumbents.



PRO-CRONY POLICY IS AGAINST SOCIAL JUSTICE

- Fosters inefficiencies by creating monopolies and barring new entrants into market.
E.g.: Connected firms before 2G spectrum allocation outperformed Sensex in pre 2010 but post 2010, they underperformed significantly.
- Inhibits creative destruction of new entrants by hurdling their access to resources.
E.g.: Telecom industry before LPG reforms.
- Erodes nation's wealth by concentrating it in a few inefficient hands and willful defaulters.
E.g.: Discretionary allocation of coal blocks.
- Firms shift their focus away from growth through competition and innovation towards building political relationships.
- Exacerbates income inequality.
E.g.: Rents sought by cronies are paid for by genuine businesses and citizens.
- Public welfare is jeopardized for private interests.
- Political relations are prioritized over talent and innovation thereby barring equal opportunities.

CONCLUSION

Goal of achieving \$5 trillion economy can go along with maximizing social justice by providing equal opportunities to all new entrants in market. Pro-business policies ensure that such competitive ecosystem is established.



30 / ED
GS - III

What are the fundamental differences between the concepts of “Global Value Chains” and “Assemble in India”? What policy perspectives are required to make “Assemble in India” a success story? (150 Words)

Economic Survey 2020 pitched for integration of “Assemble in India” into “Make in India” which further leads to job creation in labour intensive industries and also promote exports.

ASSEMBLE IN INDIA

A link in the value addition chain across the globe

Process of assembling various core parts that are manufacture by different nations

Nation needs to be integrated in GVC to realize Assemble in India

GLOBAL VALUE CHAIN

Connected links of value addition across the globe in a product's life cycle

Process starting from R&D to core part production to assembly to post sales

Picks best competitive nations for high quality, low cost assembly



IAS MAINS 2020 - VALUE ADDITION

GLOBAL VALUE CHAIN



POLICY PERSPECTIVE NEEDED TO MAKE ASSEMBLY IN INDIA A SUCCESS

- Focus on “Network Products” in manufacturing ecosystem.
- Enhance integration of India in GVCs compared to major exporting nations.
- Channelize skilled labour force towards labour intensive manufacturing.
- Infrastructure support that minimizes logistics and ease of doing business.
- Export promotion policies towards integrating with GVC.
- Reforming labour laws.
- Simplifying the taxation regime towards business-friendly ecosystem.
- Specialize more in areas of competitive advantage.

THE WAY FORWARD

India should adopt the policy focusing on network products that can create gains both in employment creation and economic growth.



What is tolerance? Elaborate the importance of tolerance. (150 Words)

Tolerance refers to respecting and accommodating the attitudes and practices of others.

IMPORTANCE OF TOLERANCE

- One's own beliefs may not be always correct. Hence, tolerance would help in correcting one's belief, or rationalizing the same.
- Tolerance promotes diversity. Otherwise, monotony sets into the functioning of the society.
- Synthesis of two sets of ideas creates a better idea and a better way of life.
- Most law and order problems arise because two groups hate the belief systems of each other. Every group seeks to establish supremacy over the other. This is because of the attitude of intolerance to another competing group. If tolerance is present in the members of two groups, then every group respects the other group and they live in harmony.
- Tolerance can help a businessman deal with every other individual who makes a business sense. Thus, economically business can grow if they can leverage strengths in every religion or group.

CONCLUSION

Tolerance is an inherent trait of Indian cultural ethos which is reflected in accommodating diverse communities under one roof. Tolerance as a value should be imbibed to children as part of education system to create harmonious society.



**Why and how should a civil servant be compassionate towards weaker sections?
(250 Words)**

Front-end employees in government offices are mostly not compassionate towards weaker sections. Weaker individuals are not even allowed inside the office. They are either not guided at all or are misguided. This makes it imperative for a civil servant to be compassionate and pass on the instructions to subordinates.

NEED FOR A CIVIL SERVANT TO BE COMPASSIONATE TOWARDS WEAKER SECTIONS

- A civil servant needs to understand that weaker sections come from faraway places. Hence, s/he needs to stay back a little longer to meet all the petitioners.
- The departments meant for the welfare of weaker sections are often poorly staffed. Hence a civil servant's compassion prods him/her to provide adequate resources for such departments to deliver the benefits of the scheme.
- Disability welfare department is an apt example for this. Many times, this department has only few individuals to support Disability Welfare Officer. This under-staffing delays the processing of application and delivery of benefits.



- Weaker sections are often socially ostracized and subjected to inhuman practices in villages. Such harassments have to be dealt with iron hand.
- A civil servant with compassion towards SCs/STs shall definitely invoke SC, ST Atrocities Act and punish perpetrators. This sends a signal to others that any harassment could lead to harsh punishments.
- Persons with disability also form a weaker section. A compassionate civil servant would:
 - ✓ Provide work space for orthopedically challenged in the ground floor.
 - ✓ Get important office documents in Braille for the benefit of visually challenged employees.
 - ✓ Conduct disabled-friendly audit for his/her office building and make his/her office disabled-friendly.
 - ✓ Sensitize the staff to treat PWD with extra care.
 - ✓ Provision of separate queue and other amenities at polling booths during elections.

CONCLUSION

Compassion towards weaker sections as a foundational civil service value can be inherently acquired or be trained to imbibe the value. In developing countries like India, a civil servant has to go beyond rules with compassion to understand the ground level problems.

Discuss the ways to ensure ethical corporate governance from the perspective of government and public. (250 Words)

Ethics in corporate governance is necessary to protect the interests of stakeholders including companies, government and public. With breach of ethics in recent times because of conflict of interest, related party transactions, shell companies are taking toll on public trust.

GOVERNMENT

- The business management should not conduct business in a manner detrimental to the interests of government. A few such means include:
 - ✓ Tax evasion
 - ✓ Flouting ecological norms
 - ✓ Flouting construction regulatory norms
 - ✓ Flouting town planning norms
 - ✓ Flouting fire safety norms
 - ✓ Flouting labor legislations
- Corporate Governance in this regard can be ensured in the following ways:
 - ✓ Formulation of clear laws after due consultation with concerned business players
 - ✓ Laying down stringent punishment attached to their violation
 - ✓ A strong enforcement mechanism
 - ✓ Easy law compliance mechanism



PUBLIC

- Every action of a business affects society necessarily because customers for whom a business is run constitute a part of society.
- Also, every business action also has collateral impact on public who are not customers also. Selfish business interests can harm public interest in the following ways:
 - ✓ Release of effluents into public water bodies
 - ✓ Release of polluted exhaust to atmosphere
 - ✓ Hoarding of goods for creating artificial demand
 - ✓ Not undertaking any CSR activity and so on
- Corporate Governance in this regard can be ensured in the following ways:
 - ✓ Treating the waste and exhaust before it is released outside
 - ✓ Reserving a portion of profit for CSR
 - ✓ Non-hoarding of essential commodities and so on.

CONCLUSION

Thus, carrying out a business in such a way as not to compromise the interests of all stakeholders in general and shareholders in particular is necessary for an ethical Corporate Governance.



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